

Support Team & Admin Panel Changes

Work report | Flavour platform (admin panel, backend API, customer mobile app) | September 2026

1. Summary

This work introduced a dedicated **support team role** to the Flavour admin panel. Administrators can now create support staff accounts, and each support member signs in to a restricted support desk where they see and handle only the customer cases assigned to them. New cases are **assigned automatically** with a limit of six open cases per member. Alongside the feature, several **security gaps were closed**, the **customer app** gained an unread-reply indicator for support conversations, and two user-facing bugs were fixed.

Area	What was delivered
Admin panel	Role selection at sign-in (Admin / Support team / Vendor), a restricted support desk, support team management, case ownership display, improved chat layout.
Backend (API)	Support member accounts, automatic case assignment, per-member case visibility, role-based permission checks, security hardening.
Customer mobile app	"New reply from support" badge on case cards; fix for a crash that stopped the live chat screen from opening.

2. Admin panel changes

2.1 Role-based sign-in

The shared login page now has a **"Sign in as"** selector with three options: Vendor partner, Admin and Support team. The page heading, icon and guidance change with the selected role, giving support staff a clear, dedicated sign-in experience ("Support Desk"). The selected role is verified by the server, so an account cannot sign in under a role it does not hold.

2.2 Restricted access for support staff

- Support members see only three pages: **Support**, **Support Cases** and **Active Chats**.
- Attempting to open any other page (dashboard, users, payments, settings, etc.) redirects them back to their cases.
- The top bar shows the signed-in member's name and a "Support Agent" label; the sidebar shows a "Support desk" badge.
- Administrators keep full access to every page and feature.

2.3 Support team management (administrators only)

- An **Add new member** button on the Support page opens a form for the member's name, email and password, with a secure password generator.
- After an account is created or a password is reset, the login details are shown **once** with copy buttons so they can be shared privately. Passwords are stored encrypted and can never be displayed again.
- A new **Support team** tab lists every member with their open-case workload (for example "4 / 6"), cases awaiting customer confirmation, and the date added.
- Administrators can **reset a password** (which signs the member out of all devices) or **remove a member** (which ends their access immediately and reassigns their open cases).

2.4 Case ownership and chat layout

- Each case card in the admin view now shows **"Assigned to ..."** or **"Unassigned"**.

- The Active Chats screen was resized to fit the browser window, so the message box and Send button are always visible; long conversations now scroll inside the chat panel.

3. Automatic case assignment

Previously every support case was visible to every staff member and nothing was assigned. Cases are now distributed automatically, whether they are raised from the customer or driver app, created by staff in the admin panel, or triggered by an emergency SOS.

Rule	Behaviour
Case limit	Each support member handles up to 6 open cases at a time.
Fair distribution	A new case goes to the member with the fewest open cases; ties go to the longest-standing member.
Awaiting confirmation	Cases waiting for the customer to confirm resolution do not count toward the limit (6 cases with one awaiting confirmation counts as 5).
Everyone at the limit	The case is assigned to the first (longest-standing) member, so no case is left without an owner.
Member removed	Their unresolved cases are redistributed using the same rules.
No members yet	Cases stay unassigned (administrators still see them) and are distributed as soon as a member is added.
Visibility	Support members see, reply to and receive live updates for only their own cases . Administrators see all cases.

The assignment rules were verified with an automated check in an isolated test database: 18 cases created at the same moment were split evenly (6 / 6 / 6), and the limit, overflow, awaiting-confirmation and member-removal rules all behaved as specified.

4. Security improvements

Keeping support staff away from administrator powers was a core requirement. Permission checks are enforced on the server, not only hidden in the interface. The following improvements were made:

Improvement	Detail
Server-side role checks	Support accounts are refused by every administrator function (users, orders list, drivers, payments, settings, coupons, banners, team management). Verified with a real support login.
Support is view-only for orders	Support staff can look up orders, order chats and invoices to help customers, but can no longer change order status, cancel orders, answer scheduled-delivery requests, or post into customer–driver order chats.
Password hashes no longer sent	Sign-in responses and user lists previously included each account's encrypted password; this is now removed from every response.
Reply integrity	Staff replies on support cases are always recorded as staff replies and can no longer be labelled as coming from the customer or the system.
Session control	Resetting a password signs the member out everywhere; removing a member ends their session immediately; the panel returns expired sessions to the login page.
Live update privacy	Real-time case updates go only to administrators, the assigned member and the customer who raised the case.

Improvement	Detail
Input validation	Email format, password length (8–72 characters) and duplicate-email checks on member accounts; ticket status values restricted to valid states.

5. Customer mobile app changes

5.1 “New reply from support” badge

On the **Your cases** screen, a case card now shows a badge when the support team has replied and the customer has not yet read it (for example “New reply from support” or “3 new replies from support”). Opening the case clears the badge, and replies that arrive while the chat is open are marked read immediately. The text is available in English, Telugu and Hindi.

5.2 Live chat crash fix

The support chat screen crashed for customers who had at least one resolved case, because of a naming conflict in the case list code. This was corrected; the screen now opens normally.

5.3 Analytics troubleshooting

A development-time error caused by Firebase Analytics not being included in older test builds was diagnosed. A temporary local switch was added to continue testing and was later removed, restoring Firebase Analytics exactly as before. Test builds need to be rebuilt to include it.

6. Testing and verification

Item	Status
Admin panel build, type-checks and lint	Passed
Backend type-checks and lint	Passed (latest order-permission change to be re-confirmed after a tool outage)
Support member lifecycle via the API (create, sign in, role enforcement, password reset, removal)	Passed against the development server
Assignment rules (automated check in an isolated database)	Passed
End-to-end checks in the browser and on a phone	Pending: checklist handed over for manual testing

7. Recommended next steps

- Complete the manual browser and phone checklist before release.
- Change the default administrator and support passwords on the live server, then deploy the backend and admin panel together.
- Run the one-off assignment script once after deployment so existing open cases get an owner.
- Fix the sign-in rate limit so that users behind a shared proxy are counted individually (currently a possible bottleneck).
- To serve more users: make driver location updates lighter, move in-memory state to Redis, and run the backend on multiple CPU cores.
- Optional: store “read” status for support replies on the server so it syncs across a customer’s devices.